

Too Hot To Handle!

Q I have a Pentium IV with Intel 865GBF motherboard, 1 GB RAM, an ATI Radeon 256 MB graphics card running Windows XP with SP2. I have a peculiar problem with processor overheating. I experienced this first when playing *SimCity 4*. Within five minutes of launching the game, I got a warning message about overheating of the heat processor. But as soon as I quit *SimCity 4*, the system normalised.

Is it a problem with my processor?

Other than this, my computer doesn't overheat even if it runs for a full day. On the boot before the OS selection, I am getting a particular message saying processor in dual channel mode, and so on, and press F4 to resume. This thing popped up recently. What could the problem be?

Mika, Via e-mail

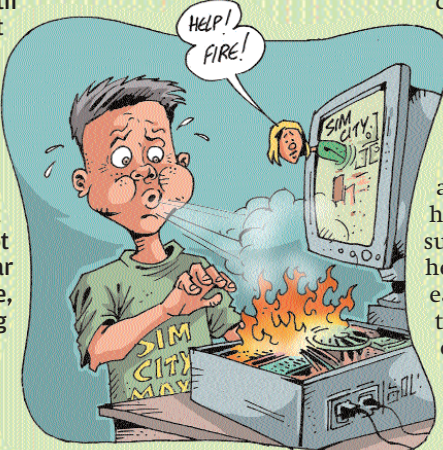
A Even if your PC is switched on the whole day, and if it's not under stress, the processor will not overheat. But when you play 3-D games that stress the processor, it tends to heat up. Intel Prescott processors are known to heat up and your processor seems to be one of those. Rest assured, this is normal.

The reason for overheating could be due to the CPU fan not working properly or the CPU and heat sink not making

proper contact thereby hindering maximum heat dissipation. Moreover, you need to check if your cabinet is properly ventilated as an improperly ventilated cabinet can also contribute to overheating.

In order to remedy the problem, check whether the CPU fan is rotating and not being blocked. It is advisable to remove the heat sink fan unit and the processor, clean it, apply a fresh, thin and uniform coat of heat sink compound on the surfaces of the processor and the heat sink that come in contact with each other and then re-assemble them. This should eliminate the cause of the overheating.

Based on the information which you have provided, we think the message that is displayed during system boot is "Memory in Dual Channel Mode" and not "Processor in Dual Channel Mode". However, this is a normal occurrence for 865 chipset-based motherboards with two memory modules. The 'Press F4 to resume' must refer to the temperature shutdown of the motherboard and not due to the dual channel memory setting.



to recover even with a fast processor. The software uses the brute-force technique of password breaking, and how fast it can find the password is dependent on the number-crunching capability of the processor.

Now You C!

Q My PC runs two OSes, Windows 98 on the C drive and Windows XP on the D drive. A few days ago, I installed the Windows version of the C language. Recently, I uninstalled it and started getting an error message at startup in the Windows 98 OS:

"There is an error in your CONFIG.SYS file on Line 2

The following file is missing or corrupted:D:\C700\BIN\SMARTDRV.EXE

There is an error in your CONFIG.SYS file on Line 8 Incorrect DOS version

The following file is missing or corrupted:COMMAND.COM

C:\>D:\C700\BIN\SMARTDRV.EXE

Bad command or file name

C:\>PATH= D:\C700\BIN;D:\WINDOWS\System32;

D:\WINDOWS; D:\WINDOWS\System32\Wbem

C:\>SET LIB= D:\C700\LIB;D:\C700\MFC\LIB

C:\>SET INCLUDE= D:\C700\INCLUDE;

D:\C700\MFC\INCLUDE

C:\>SET HELPFILES= D:\C700\HELP*.HLP

C:\>SET INIT= D:\C700\INIT"

Why is this happening?

Ravi Ranjan, via e-mail

A The problem with your system is that one of the startup files for Windows 98, config.sys, contains invalid commands that were added to it when you installed C for

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Windows. Now when you uninstalled C, the changes to config.sys have not been undone, and since those commands are no longer valid, you get the error.

In order to correct this problem, open config.sys in a text editor such as Notepad. The config.sys file might be hidden and read-only, and you might have to reset its attributes. To do this, go to the Windows command prompt and type in the following commands:

CD\

ATTRIB -S -H -R CONFIG.SYS

You'll now be able to edit config.sys.

Go to line number 2, and type in 'REM' and a space at the start of the line.

Similarly, go to line number 8, type

'REM' and a space at the start. After adding 'REM', save the file and restart your computer. Everything should work fine now. 'REM' is short for 'Remark Comments', and stops lines from getting executed. Similarly, to uncomment any line, just delete the word 'REM' from the start of the line.

Registry Backup In Win98

Q I have a Pentium III 500 MHz processor, an Intel BX motherboard, 128 MB of RAM and a 20 GB hard disk. I have Windows 98 installed. How do I back up my registry?

Rajesh Bhatt, Mumbai

A There is a utility in Windows 98 to check, backup and restore the registry, known as SCANREGW. Go to Start > Run. Enter "SCANREGW" and hit [Enter]. You'll be asked if you want to back up the registry. Click 'Yes', and your registry will be backed up. ■

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